

TENRECS

From Africa and Madagascar, tenrecs have diverse body forms, resembling the unrelated shrews, mice, hedgehogs, and otters. They range in weight from 5g (³/₁₆ oz) to more than 1 kg (2¼ lb). Largely nocturnal and with poor eyesight, these insectivores use their sensitive whiskers to locate food.

LESSER
HEDGEHOG TENREC
Echinops telfairi

Its hairs modified into spines, this species bears a remarkable resemblance to a true hedgehog, sharing its defence of rolling into a ball.

10–17 cm
4–6½ in

white-tipped
spines on back



LOWLAND STREAKED TENREC
Hemicentetes semispinosus

A tail-less tenrec, the coarse, spiny coat of this species is distinctively two-tone – black, with yellow stripes and crown bristles.

10–18 cm
4–7 in



COMMON TENREC
Tenrec ecaudatus

A large terrestrial tenrec, with red-brown fur and spines along the body, the females have up to 29 teats, more than any other mammal.



10–12 cm
4–4¾ in

RICE TENREC
Oryzorictes sp.

A burrower with well-developed forelimbs, long claws, and small eyes and ears, this tenrec can become very numerous in marshes and rice paddies.



14–23 cm
5½–9 in

GREATER
HEDGEHOG TENREC
Setifer setosus

Widespread throughout Madagascar, even in urban habitats, this species has a diverse diet, from insects, earthworms, and carrion to fruit.

AARDVARK

The only species in the Orycteropodidae, the **aardvark** is adapted for digging. It has an arched back, thick skin, long ears, and a tubular snout.

The aardvark's toes (four on the front foot and five on the hind) each have a flattened nail used to dig burrows and excavate insect nests, which it detects through its keen sense of smell.

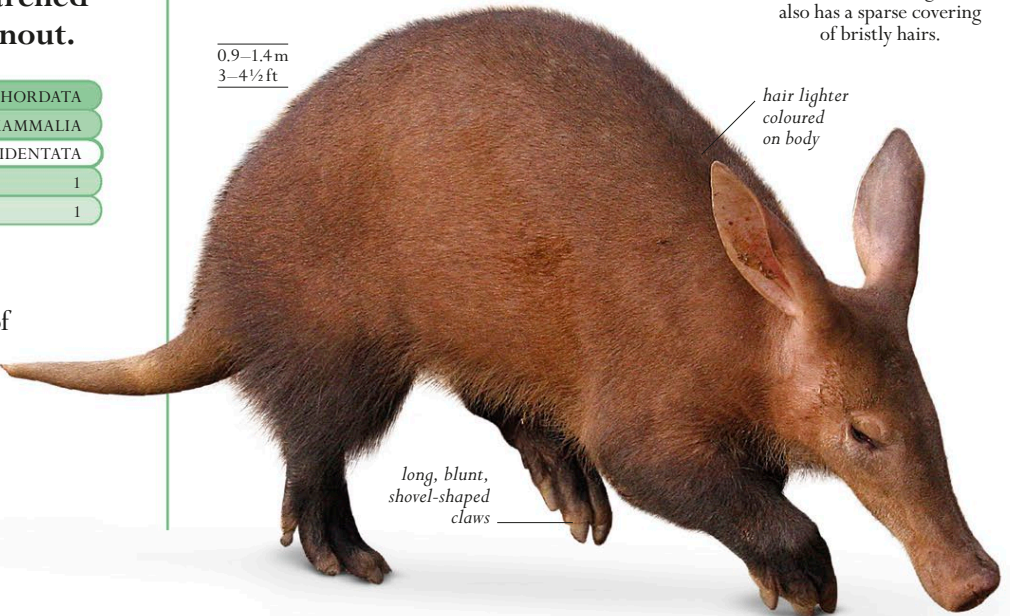
It uses its long, thin tongue to catch huge numbers of insects. Its teeth are very unusual, and are one of the main reasons for it being classified in its own order. The aardvark is born with incisors and canines at the front of the jaw, but when these fall out they are not replaced. The rear teeth lack enamel, are open-rooted, and grow throughout life.

PHYLUM	CHORDATA
CLASS	MAMMALIA
ORDER	TUBULIDENTATA
FAMILIES	1
SPECIES	1

AARDVARK

Inhabiting savanna and bushland in sub-Saharan Africa, aardvarks are solitary and nocturnal. Powerful front legs with flattened claws are used to dig into the nests of ants and termites for food.

0.9–1.4 m
3–4½ ft



AARDVARK
Orycteropus afer

The yellowish skin of the aardvark is often stained red by soil, in which it burrows and forages. It also has a sparse covering of bristly hairs.

hair lighter
coloured
on body

long, blunt,
shovel-shaped
claws